

ISSUE 58

SEPTEMBER 20, 2026



LAST WEEK IN TÜRKİYE

A weekly roundup of the top news
and developments in Türkiye



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REMINDERS BY NUMBERS



550 DAYS

since Ekrem Imamoglu was arrested.
The indictment seeks up to 2,430 years
in prison



79 DAYS

since comedian Deniz Göktaş was
arrested. He remains in prison awaiting
trial over charges related to his stand-up
show. The court decided to release him,
re-arrested before leaving prison.



63 DAYS

since Nasuh Mahruki, AKUT
rescue group founder, jailed in
pretrial detention on charges of
“inciting the public to hatred and
hostility on a post on X.



51 DAYS

since elected Üsküdar Mayor Sinem
Dedetaş was jailed pending trial,
despite not being convicted of any
crime.





AT LEAST 81 JAILED IN OPERATIONS TARGETING LGBTI+ GROUPS

At least 81 people had been placed in pretrial detention by September 17 in Türkiye's "Ailem Güvende" ("My Family Is Safe") investigation. Launched on September 12 across 15 provinces, the operation involved legal action against 162 people, nine associations and 13 businesses. Those jailed include seven Kaos GL board members and journalist Tuğba Tekerek, whose detention concerned her reporting on Georgia's LGBTI+ movement. Prosecutors in Istanbul alleged that the organizations undermined the Turkish family structure, citing protection of children, families and public morality as grounds for detention.



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BIANET



CENSORSHIP EXPANDS TO MEDIA AND HUMAN RIGHTS GROUPS

Türkiye's social media crackdown expanded on September 14, targeting Evrensel newspaper, Amnesty International Türkiye, the Media and Law Studies Association (MLSA), and Academics for Peace. X blocked access within Türkiye to the latter three organizations' accounts, while Evrensel's remained accessible despite a government blocking request. The measures followed a September 12 court order targeting LGBTI+ organizations and activists, which resulted in 14 X accounts being blocked. Eleven Instagram accounts also faced blocking orders, though these had not yet been implemented at the time of reporting.





LGBTI+ PARENTS’ ADVOCATE JAILED IN “MY FAMILY IS SAFE” OPERATION

Nedime Erdoğan, a mother and member of the Ankara Rainbow Families Association (GALADER), was placed in pretrial detention and sent to Sincan Prison under the “Ailem Güvende” (“My Family Is Safe”) operation, Medyascope reported on September 19.

Erdoğan has spent years advocating for her child and other LGBTI+ people. In writings highlighted by Kaos GL, she argued that policies presented as protecting families instead isolate LGBTI+ people and their parents. “Our children are not threats, but dignified human beings,” she wrote.



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MEDYASCOPE @YOUTUBE



BELGIN ÇELİK, 70, DETAINED ON ANNIVERSARY OF 1980 COUP

Belgin Çelik, a 70-year-old trans rights advocate and Lambdaistanbul co-founder, was among those detained in Türkiye's "Ailem Güvende" ("My Family Is Safe") operations. According to the video interview, police raided her Ankara home on September 12—the 46th anniversary of the military coup whose aftermath she survived. She spent four days in custody before being released; prosecutors reportedly cited her age when requesting judicial supervision rather than pretrial detention.



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MEDYASCOPE, EURONEWS



JUSTICE MINISTER SAYS 2028 ELECTION WILL BE HELD TO REELECT ERDOĞAN

Speaking to AKP officials in Adana on September 18, Türkiye's Justice Minister Akın Gürlek said, "An election will be held in 2028 to reelect our president." He urged party members to campaign together for Recep Tayyip Erdoğan, emphasizing their responsibility in securing his reelection. Gürlek did not specify an election date or explain the legal mechanism for Erdoğan's renewed candidacy. His remarks followed presidential adviser Mehmet Uçum's statement that a parliamentary decision to renew elections could enable Erdoğan to run for another term.



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MEDYASCOPE



ÜSKÜDAR COUNCIL MEMBER NAMED DEPUTY MAYOR AFTER SWITCHING TO AKP

Tahsin Usta, one of four Üsküdar council members who switched from the CHP to the AKP, has been appointed deputy mayor, Medyascope reported on September 16. The party switches helped the AKP regain control of the municipality following elected mayor Sinem Dedetaş's arrest. In a September 8 council vote, the AKP's Dünder Ziya Gültekin was elected acting mayor by 23 votes to 19, reversing the CHP's March 2024 electoral victory.



DIESEL NEARS ₺100 PER LITER IN TÜRKIYE

Diesel prices rose by approximately ₺6.62 per liter on September 15, reaching ₺95.60 on Istanbul's European side, ₺96.75 in Ankara and ₺97.02 in İzmir. Prices climbed as high as ₺98.47 in eastern provinces, approaching the ₺100 threshold. Medyascope linked the increase to rising global oil prices and exchange-rate fluctuations. Gasoline and LPG prices remained unchanged. Industry representatives warned that higher transport and logistics costs could drive up food and consumer-goods prices, while farmers and municipalities also faced increased fuel expenses.



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MEDYASCOPE

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TÜRKİYE'S FUND CRISIS PROMPTS LIQUIDATIONS AND ARRESTS

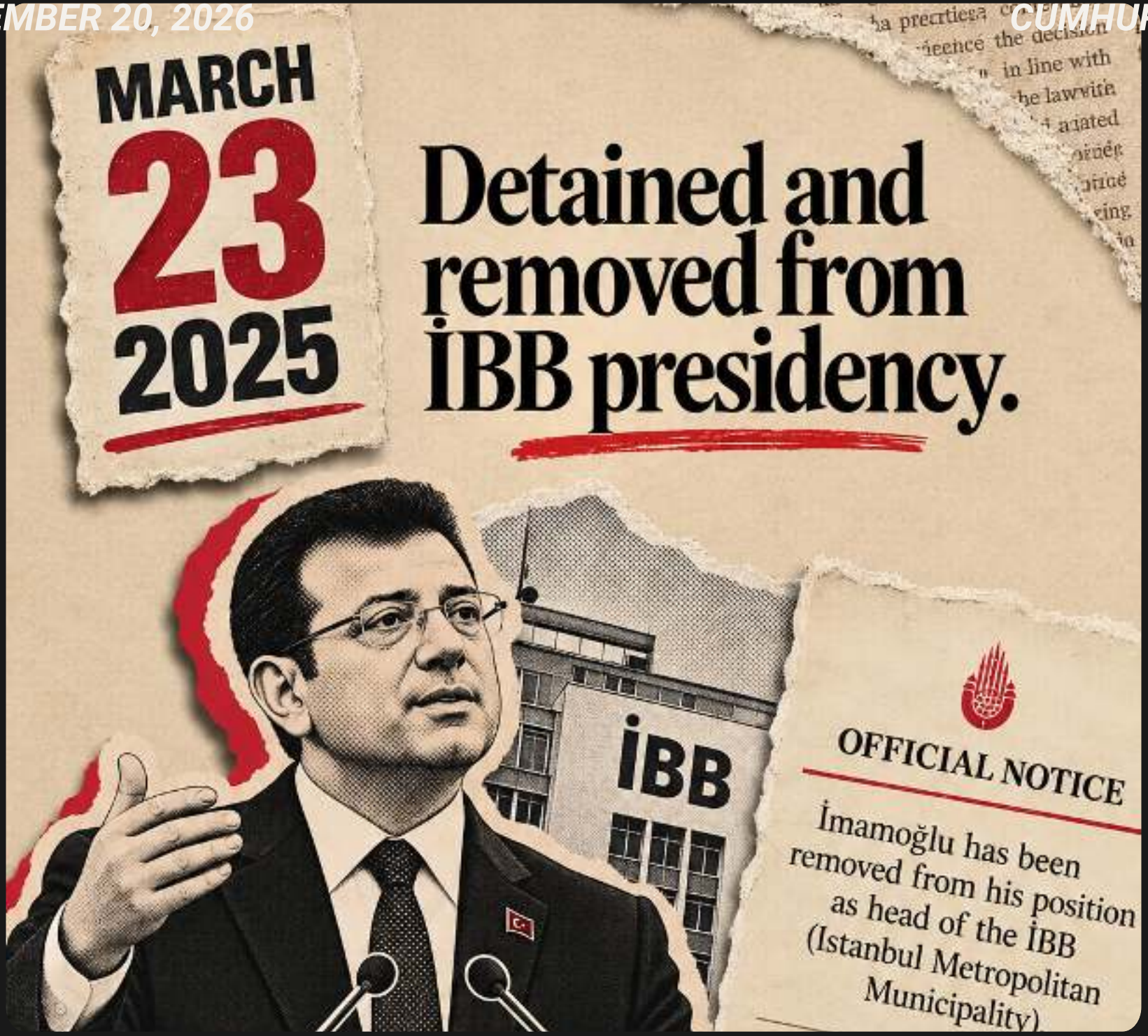
Türkiye's markets regulator ordered around 130 funds into liquidation on September 17 following defaults at Pusula and Tera funds. The affected funds held ₺826 billion and had over 514,000 investors. The BIST 100 fell 8.18% that week. İşbank and Ziraat Bank will oversee liquidation, while the central bank increased funding.

Four people were placed in pretrial detention in the fund investigation. Separately, 16 were placed in pretrial detention over social media posts, and access to 246 accounts was blocked.



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CUMHURİYET



İMAMOĞLU PUBLISHES “CHRONOLOGY OF BANS

Jailed Istanbul Mayor and presidential candidate Ekrem İmamoğlu released a video on September 20 listing restrictions imposed over the past 18 months. These included the cancellation of his university diploma, blocks on his and his campaign office’s social media accounts, restrictions on the use of his image and voice, and an order to confiscate Millet Şahidimdir, a book compiling his courtroom defense. He also said he had been prevented from presenting his defense in court.



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